



VELLICHOR

RARE WHISKEY & FINE WINE, TOKENIZED

Vellichor — Rare Whiskey & Fine Wine, Tokenized on Robinhood Chain

Whitepaper v0.2 — July 2026

“Own rare whiskey and fine wine as RWAs. Vaulted. Liquid. Tradable.”

Table of Contents

01 Abstract	3
02 The Problem: Five Structural Barriers in Rare Spirits Investing	3
03 The Vellichor Solution	4
04 How It Works	4
05 Why Robinhood Chain	5
06 Token Structure	6
07 Curation Standard	6
08 Legal & Compliance Considerations	7
09 Roadmap	7
10 Risks	8
11 Conclusion	8

01 Abstract

Rare whiskey and fine wine have outperformed many traditional asset classes over the last two decades, but the market that trades them has barely modernized. Selling a bottle still means months at an auction house. Holding one properly means paying for climate-controlled storage most collectors never budget for. And buying one internationally means trusting a stranger's word that it isn't a professionally refilled fake.

Vellichor is a Real World Asset (RWA) protocol that solves these problems directly by combining professional curation and custody with on-chain fractional ownership — the Fractional Vault model. Vellichor sources, authenticates, and stores rare bottles in professional, insured, climate-controlled vaults, then issues on-chain Vault Units that represent verifiable, tradable ownership of those bottles, on Robinhood Chain, the Ethereum Layer-2 network that reached public mainnet on July 1, 2026.

02 The Problem: Five Structural Barriers in Rare Spirits Investing

2.1 Illiquidity

A collector cannot sell a rare bottle the way they'd sell a stock or a gram of gold. Exiting a position typically means registering with an auction house such as Sotheby's or Christie's, or a specialist dealer platform — a process that runs from authentication, to catalog placement, to auction date, to final settlement, often taking months from decision to cash in hand.

2.2 Holding Cost

Investment-grade bottles cannot simply sit in a cabinet at home. In hot, humid climates especially, heat and humidity degrade the cork seal and the liquid inside, destroying value outright. Proper storage means paying annual fees for a professional bonded warehouse with tight temperature control (typically 12–14°C) and full insurance — and the small number of facilities that meet investment-grade standards are concentrated in a handful of locations such as Singapore, the UK, and continental Europe, out of reach for most individual collectors to arrange or verify themselves.

2.3 Counterfeiting

Because a single bottle can be worth tens of thousands of dollars, the category is a target for sophisticated counterfeiters — including schemes where a genuine empty bottle from a luxury restaurant is refilled with cheap spirit and resealed. Without a clear, verifiable provenance trail from a reputable source, a collection is effectively unsellable to serious international buyers, who will not take on that risk.

2.4 Physical Degradation & Oxidation

Whiskey doesn't age further once bottled, but its physical components still degrade over time if mishandled. Unlike wine, whiskey bottles must be stored upright — high alcohol content will corrode a cork if the bottle is stored lying down. But stored upright for years without humidity control, the cork can dry out, crack, and let oxygen in, oxidizing the liquid and destroying the bottle's value just as surely as a fake would.

2.5 The “Limited Edition” Trap

Many modern distilleries capitalize on collector demand by releasing large volumes of bottles marketed as “Limited Edition,” “Special Release,” or “Collector's Series.” Not everything labeled limited is actually investment-grade — a lot of it is manufactured scarcity through premium packaging, with liquid inside that has no real historical or qualitative pull with serious collectors. New investors routinely buy into these releases and find the resale value has collapsed by the time they try to sell.

03 The Vellichor Solution

Vellichor is built specifically to remove each of these five barriers:

Problem	How Vellichor solves it
Illiquidity	Every bottle is split into Vault Units, tradable 24/7 on Robinhood Chain. Exiting a position is a transaction, not a months-long auction cycle.
Holding cost	Vellichor vaults every bottle in professional, insured, climate-controlled storage before it's ever listed. The cost is shared across unit holders through a small custody fee instead of falling entirely on one investor arranging their own warehouse.
Counterfeiting	Every bottle is authenticated and curated by Vellichor before it enters the vault, and its provenance documentation is attached permanently to its on-chain record — visible to any buyer, anywhere, without needing to trust a stranger's word.
Degradation & oxidation	Bottles are stored and monitored by professional vault operators under correct conditions (upright, humidity-controlled), not left to individual collectors to store, ship, or mishandle.
The "limited edition" trap	Vellichor's curation criteria filter for bottles with genuine collector demand and secondary-market track record — not packaging-driven scarcity. If it doesn't meet the bar, it doesn't get vaulted.

Unlike a pooled fund or a blind “pack” mechanic, every Vault Unit buyer knows exactly which bottle, vintage, and provenance they are buying a share of — the underlying asset already exists in the vault, authenticated and insured, before any token is sold.

04 How It Works

4.1 Acquisition & Curation

Vellichor acquires a bottle at fair market price, and verifies authenticity, condition, and provenance against its curation standard before it is eligible for vaulting.

4.2 Vaulting

The bottle is logged, photographed, and placed into insured, professional storage under correct conditions for its category. A digital provenance file (photos, certificate, purchase history, storage conditions) is attached to the token's metadata.

4.3 Tokenization

Vellichor mints an ERC-1155 token series for the bottle. Example:

Field	Example
Bottle	Macallan 30 Year, 1980s release
Total value at listing	\$18,000
Total Vault Units	100
Price per unit	\$180
Token standard	ERC-1155 on Robinhood Chain

4.4 Sale & Trading

Units are sold directly on the Vellichor Market. After the initial sale, units are freely tradable peer-to-peer or on any Robinhood Chain-compatible venue, giving holders an exit at any time — the direct answer to the illiquidity problem in Section 2.1.

4.5 Redemption

Any holder who acquires 100% of a bottle's units may initiate redemption — whether those units were bought directly at listing, purchased afterward from other holders on the Market, or a mix of both. Once consolidated: units are burned, identity/compliance checks are completed (required for alcohol shipping), and the physical bottle is shipped, insured, to the redeemer.

4.6 Ongoing Custody Fee

A small annual vaulting fee (paid in USDG or the native settlement asset) covers insurance, storage, and security, deducted proportionally from unit holders or paid by the protocol treasury from marketplace fees — the shared-cost answer to Section 2.2.

05 Why Robinhood Chain

Robinhood Chain is an Ethereum Layer-2 built on Arbitrum's Orbit stack that reached public mainnet on July 1, 2026. It was purpose-built for tokenized real-world assets and gives Vellichor:

- **Distribution** — direct access to Robinhood's existing retail user base and wallet infrastructure.
- **24/7 settlement** — continuous trading for Vault Units, replacing the auction-house cycle described in Section 2.1.
- **DeFi composability** — Vault Units can plug into lending markets and DEXs already live on the chain (e.g., Uniswap, Morpho-powered lending).
- **Low-cost, fast settlement** — sub-second block times and low gas costs suited to frequent secondary trading of fractional units.

Note: Robinhood Chain's own Stock Tokens are structured as debt securities rather than direct equity ownership, and U.S. regulators have signaled increased scrutiny of similar tokenized-ownership structures. Vellichor's legal wrapper (Section 8) is designed with this regulatory context in mind. Vellichor is an independent protocol and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or a product of Robinhood Markets, Inc.

06 Token Structure

- **Standard:** ERC-1155 (multi-token standard — one contract, many bottle “series,” each with its own supply of fungible units).
- **Unit token** — represents fractional ownership of one specific bottle. Non-inflationary: total units per bottle are fixed at mint.
- **\$VELLICHOR (utility/governance token, optional phase 2)** — used for marketplace fee discounts, priority access to new bottle drops, and governance over which bottles are acquired next.

07 Curation Standard

To directly address Sections 2.3 and 2.5, every bottle considered for vaulting is evaluated against:

- **Authenticated provenance** — verifiable chain of ownership and/or purchase from a reputable auction house, distillery, or dealer.
- **Secondary-market track record** — evidence of genuine collector demand and price history, not just packaging or marketing claims.
- **Physical condition** — fill level, seal integrity, and label condition assessed before vaulting.
- **Category fit** — bottles with recognized historical, rarity, or quality standing within whiskey, bourbon, scotch, or fine wine collecting communities.

Bottles that don't clear this bar are not vaulted, regardless of how they were marketed at release.

08 Legal & Compliance Considerations

Fractional ownership of a physical asset sold to the public can be treated as a security in many jurisdictions, independent of the underlying asset type. Vellichor's approach:

- Each bottle (or a pool of bottles) is intended to be held through a dedicated legal wrapper (e.g., an SPV) that holds title to the physical asset, with Vault Units representing a beneficial interest issued by that entity.
- Redemption and shipment of alcohol is subject to jurisdiction-specific licensing, age verification, and import/export rules; redemption will require KYC and may not be available in all regions.
- Vellichor does not currently offer investment advice; Vault Units are a claim on a specific physical asset, not a guarantee of return.

This document is for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal, tax, or investment advice. Vellichor intends to work with qualified legal counsel in relevant jurisdictions prior to public token sales.

09 Roadmap

Phase	Milestone
Phase 0	Brand, whitepaper, smart contract testnet deployment on Robinhood Chain testnet
Phase 1	Genesis vault: launch with the first curated bottle, direct-sale Vault Units, Market opens — additional bottles vaulted one at a time as each is sourced and authenticated
Phase 2	\$VELLICHOR utility token, token-gated priority access to curated drops, community governance over acquisitions
Phase 3	Secondary marketplace liquidity, DeFi collateral integration
Phase 4	First redemption completed
Phase 5	Expansion to additional spirit categories and international vaulting partners

Redemption itself is not a feature gated to a later phase — the mechanism in VellichorVault.sol is live from Phase 0/1 onward. Any holder who consolidates 100% of a bottle's outstanding Vault Units, whether bought directly at listing or acquired afterward from other holders on the Market, can redeem at any time. “First redemption completed” in Phase 4 marks the milestone of that happening in practice, once secondary liquidity makes full consolidation more achievable — it does not mean redemption is switched on only at that point.

10 Risks

- **Valuation risk** — rare spirits and wine prices can be volatile despite tokenization improving liquidity.
- **Custody risk** — reliance on third-party vault operators and insurers.
- **Regulatory risk** — securities and alcohol-import regulation vary by jurisdiction and may change.
- **Smart contract risk** — despite audits, on-chain contracts carry inherent technical risk.
- **Redemption risk** — full-unit redemption requires 100% consolidation of ownership and compliance clearance, which may take time.
- **Curation risk** — even with a defined standard, collector taste and secondary-market demand can shift over time.

11 Conclusion

The five barriers that have kept rare whiskey and fine wine out of reach for most investors — illiquidity, holding cost, counterfeiting, physical degradation, and manufactured scarcity — aren't solved by tokenization alone. They're solved by pairing tokenization with real curation and real custody. That pairing is Vellichor: transparent about what's being bought, professionally vaulted, and built for a path to real liquidity on Robinhood Chain.

Vellichor — Own rare whiskey and fine wine as RWAs. Vaulted. Liquid. Tradable.